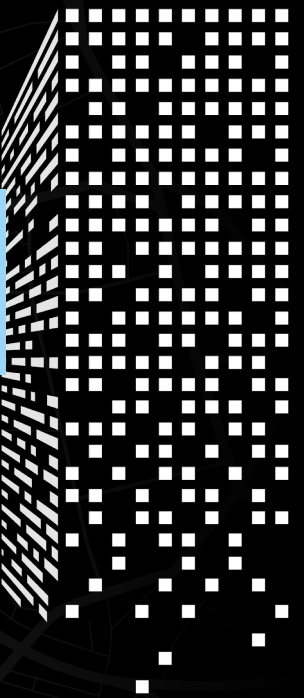




between presence and ruin

in conversation with:
“Not the Footnote: Zines as Methodological Guides” &
“Queer in Public. Queer in Collapse”

by chris armstrong (they/them)



1

zines as methodological guides

01

what is it?

05

methodological harm

02

conditions of knowledge

06

knowledge in motion

03

the third space

07

methods of care

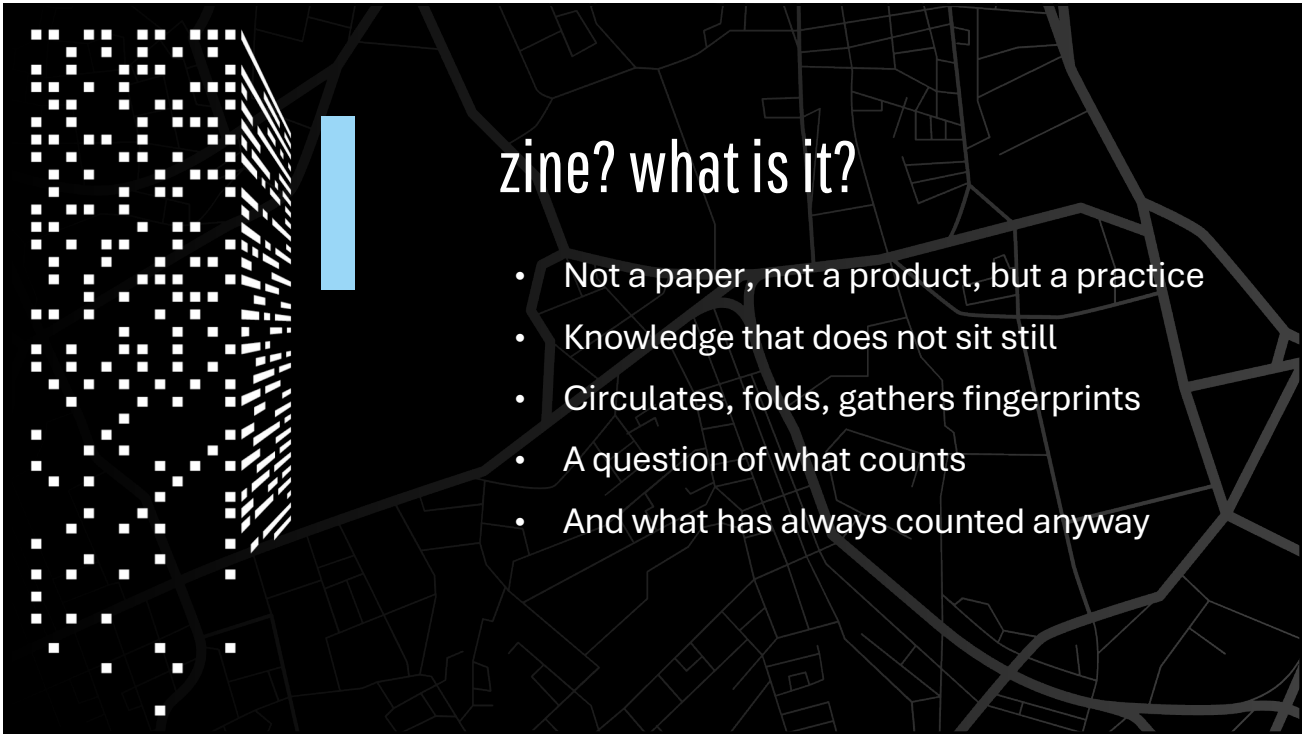
04

queer archives and
resistance

08

calls to action

2



zine? what is it?

- Not a paper, not a product, but a practice
- Knowledge that does not sit still
- Circulates, folds, gathers fingerprints
- A question of what counts
- And what has always counted anyway

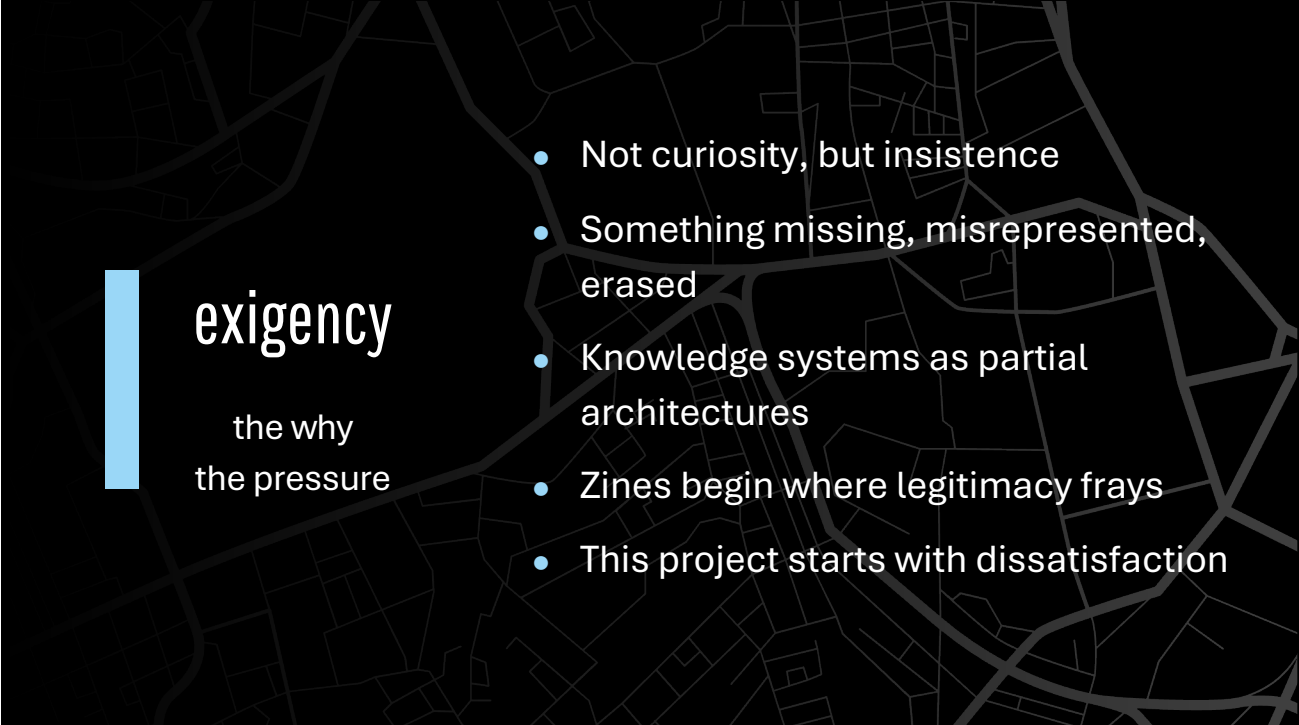
3



enter here

- Read sideways, diagonally, incompletely . This is not linear.
- Pause, skip, return
- Understanding is optional
- Attention is enough
- A methodology of movement, not mastery

4



exigency

the why
the pressure

- Not curiosity, but insistence
- Something missing, misrepresented, erased
- Knowledge systems as partial architectures
- Zines begin where legitimacy frays
- This project starts with dissatisfaction

5



zines as third space : between, within, against

reside
not fully institutional.
not fully inside.

rigor
rigor without polish

relational
knowledge can be partial, personal, and collaborative

6



tension

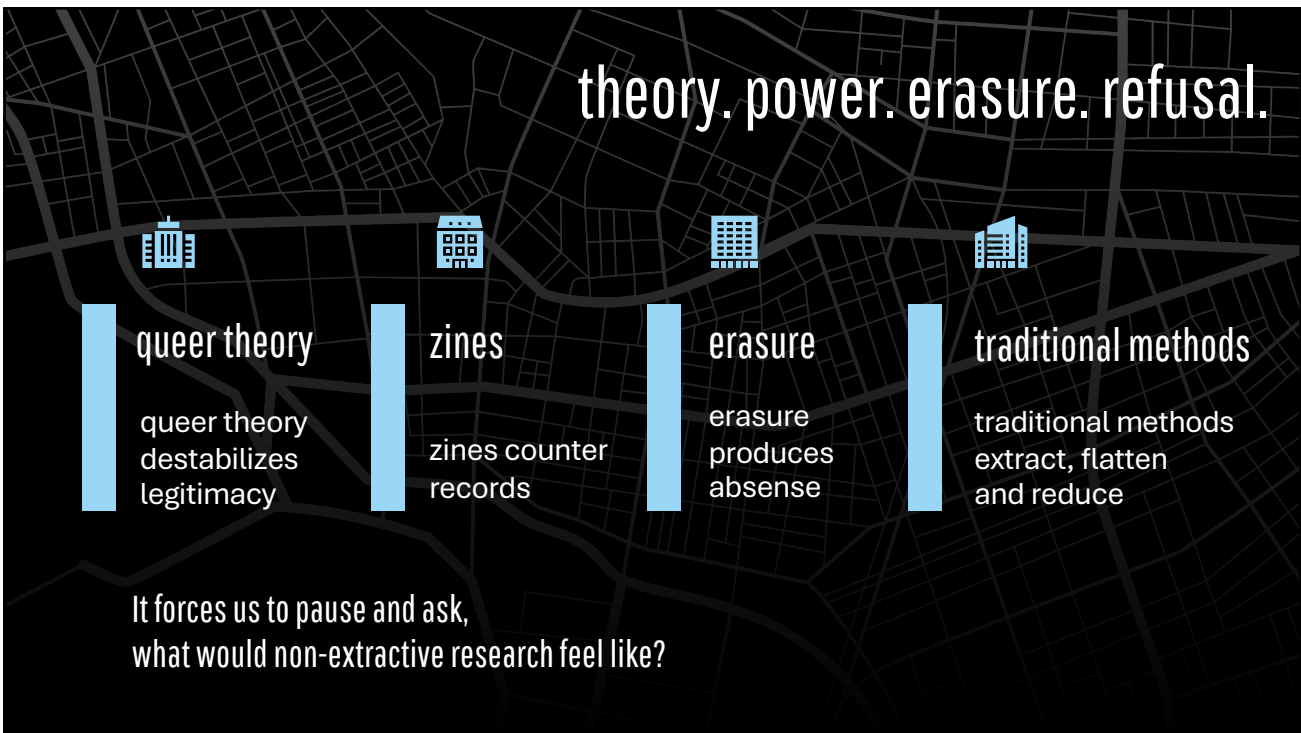
recognition versus preservation

- Recognition says this matters
- Preservation says hold it still
- Zines resist stillness

questions

- Can we study without containing?
- Can we care without fixing?

7



theory. power. erasure. refusal.



queer theory

queer theory destabilizes legitimacy



zines

zines counter records



erasure

erasure produces absence

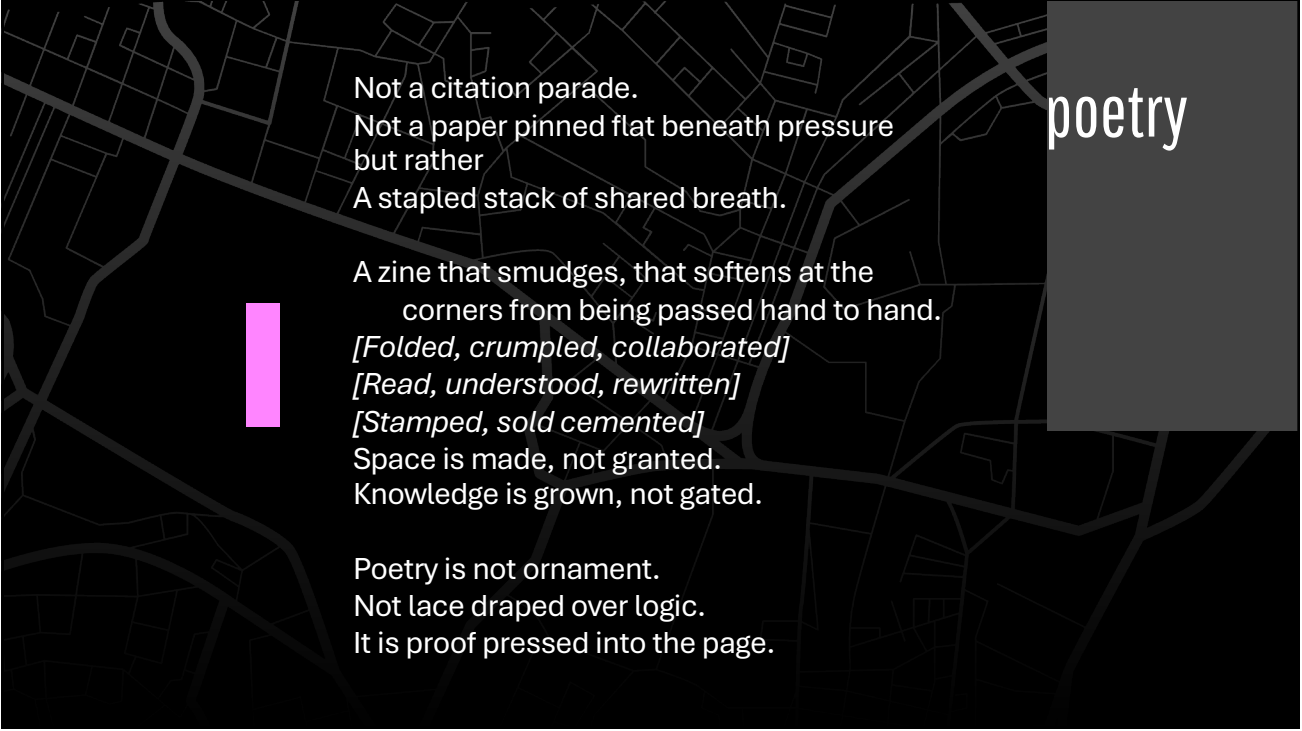


traditional methods

traditional methods extract, flatten and reduce

It forces us to pause and ask,
what would non-extractive research feel like?

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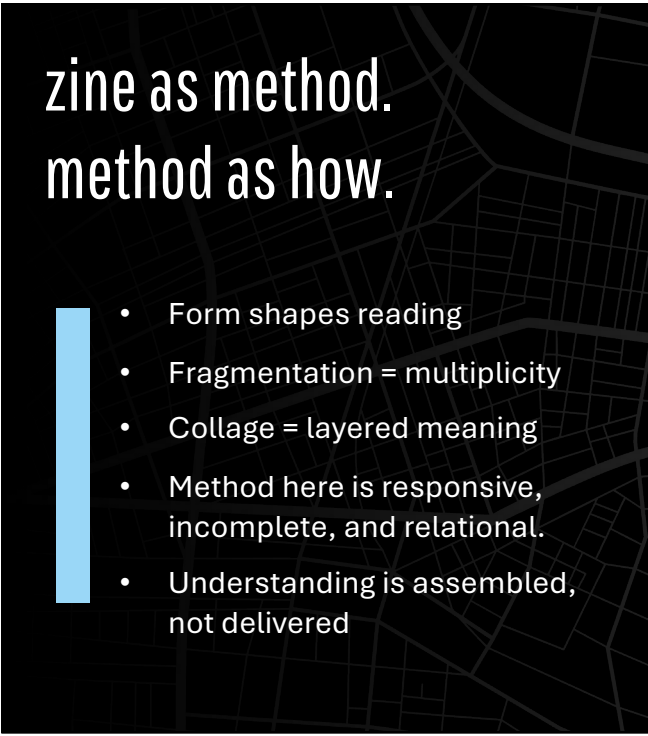
poetry

Not a citation parade.
Not a paper pinned flat beneath pressure
but rather
A stapled stack of shared breath.

A zine that smudges, that softens at the
corners from being passed hand to hand.
[Folded, crumpled, collaborated]
[Read, understood, rewritten]
[Stamped, sold cemented]
Space is made, not granted.
Knowledge is grown, not gated.

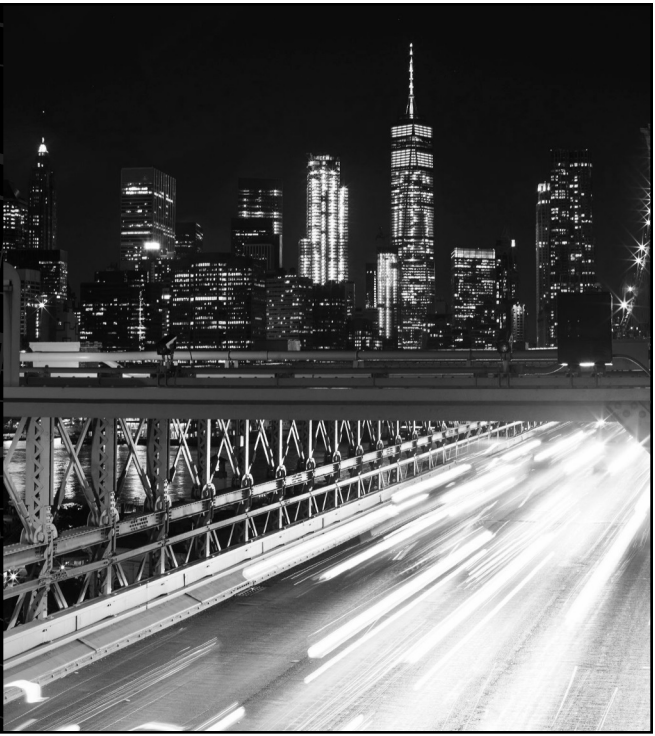
Poetry is not ornament.
Not lace draped over logic.
It is proof pressed into the page.

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zine as method.
method as how.

- Form shapes reading
- Fragmentation = multiplicity
- Collage = layered meaning
- Method here is responsive, incomplete, and relational.
- Understanding is assembled, not delivered



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care as method. ethics of attention.

resist extraction

honor labor & vulnerability

let ambiguity remain

Zines as care:

- made without guarantee
- shared without expectation
- received without obligation
- Care lives in the sending

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zines. in closing.

Zines serve as
Archive
Method
Theory
Care

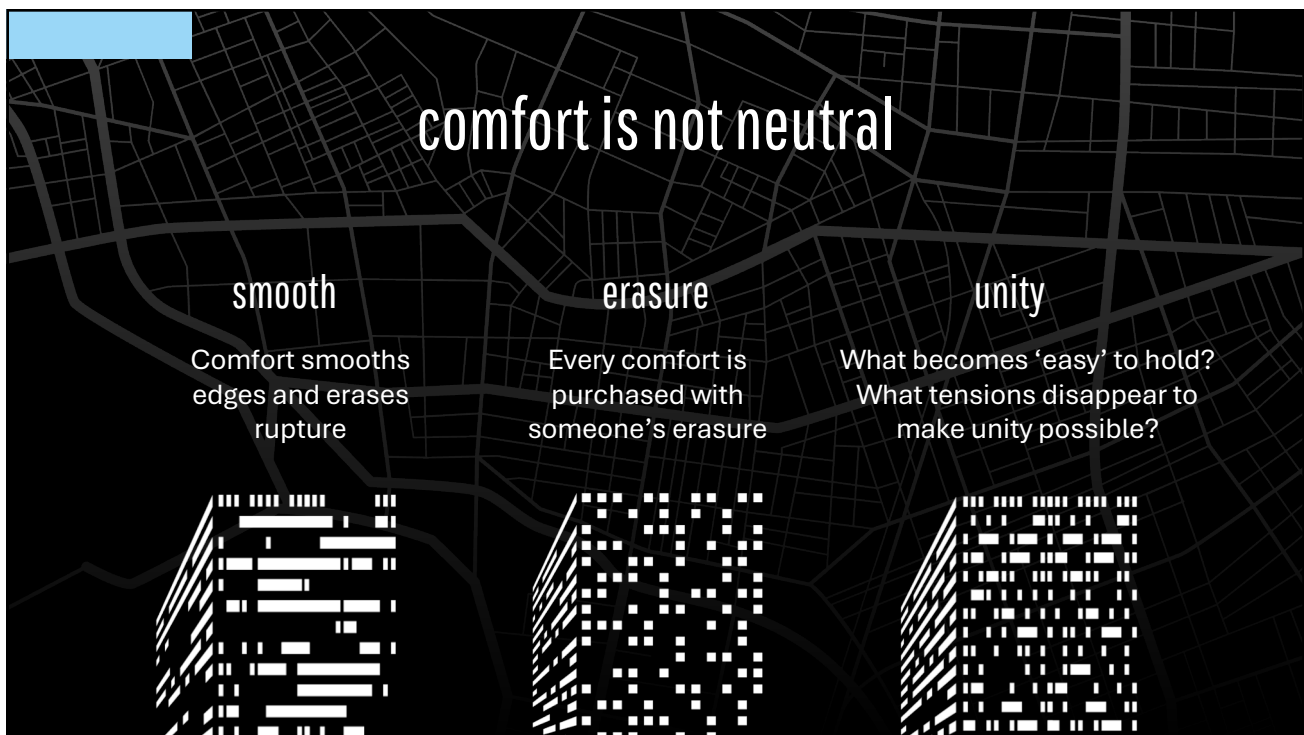
They move
They circulate
They remain unfinished

Not just objects of study
but a way of studying.
Pass it on

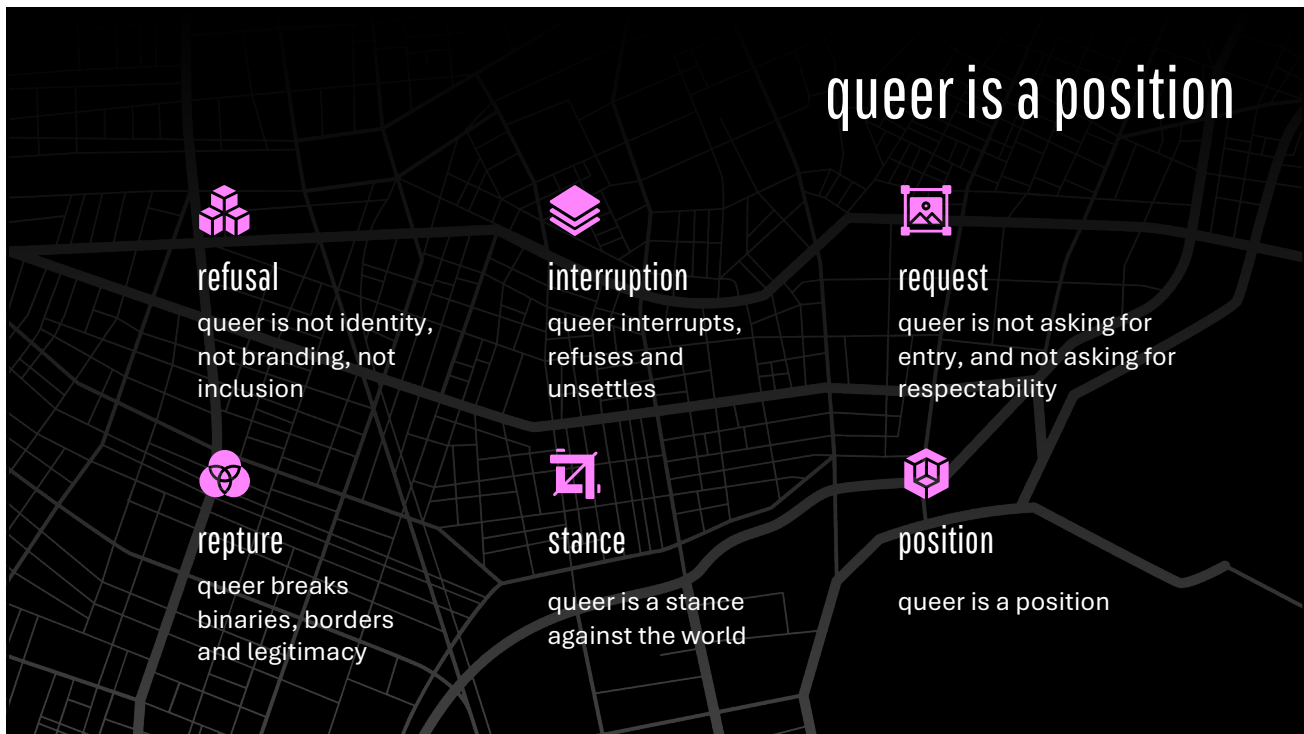
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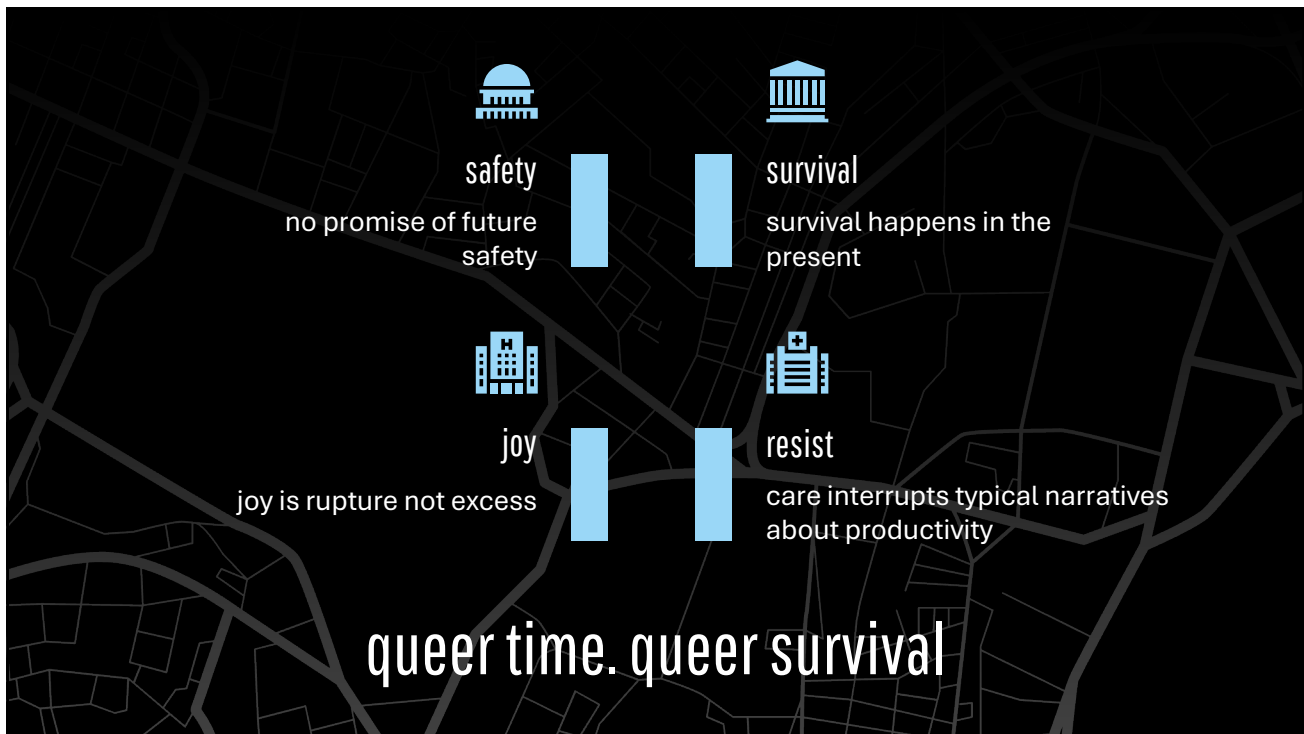
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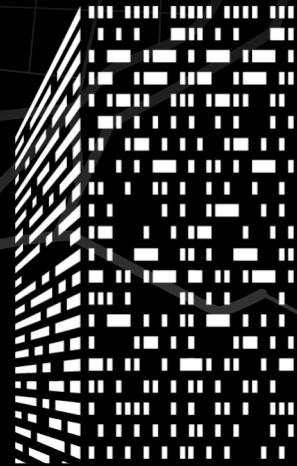
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queer in public. queer in collapse. in closing

These calls are not a map but provocations to be wrestled with, resisted, reshaped. Queer is not an identity to defend or enclose; it is a living practice, a constant pressure against what is fixed, a refusal of what is given. It moves, disrupts, insists. It is not what we are so much as what we do—how we challenge, how we imagine otherwise, how we refuse to let each other disappear. Queer is the ongoing act of keeping one another alive.



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thank you for being here! lets stay connected



Chris Armstrong, They/Them

carmstrong1@unm.edu

[linkedin.com/this-chris-armstrong](https://www.linkedin.com/in/this-chris-armstrong)

PhD Student | Health Equity Sciences, WGSS and Sociology | Focused on Queer and Trans Liberation, Community Based Participatory Research, and Arts Based Research

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